CHATBOT REVIEW · ZOHO SALESIQ

Zoho's chatbot options, *and why they fall short for us.*

Zoho SalesIQ comes with our CRM Plus plan, so I checked every way it lets us put a chatbot on the website. For each option, the pages ahead show a sample chat: one question it handles well, and one it can't.

PREPARED FOR **DATASPHERE EDU SOLUTIONS** PREPARED BY **VENKATESH BIRADAR** DATE **12 OCT 2026**

WHAT ZOHO OFFERS	WHAT THEY'RE GOOD AT	WHERE THEY FAIL
Three bot types in SalesIQ: a flow builder (Zobot), a FAQ bot (Answer Bot), and Zobot with SalesIQ Scripts.	Collecting a student's details and passing the chat to our team.	Understanding a student's question, suggesting the right course, and matching our site's design.

01

What a good chatbot must do for us

Correct answers Fees, duration, syllabus, batches, online or classroom.	**Suggests courses** Understands the student's goal and points to the right course.	**Easy to update** The team can change a fee or date without a developer.
Saves leads Name, phone and course reach Zoho CRM.	**Hands over** Offers a call-back when it can't help.	**Matches our design** Looks like part of the new website, not a third-party add-on.

02

How Zoho adds a chatbot to the website

STUDENT
Clicks the chat bubble on our site

→

SALESIQ WIDGET
Chat window, added with one script

→

BOT BRAIN · PICK ONE
1. Zobot (flow)
2. Answer Bot
3. Zobot + Scripts

→

ZOHO CRM PLUS
Lead saved

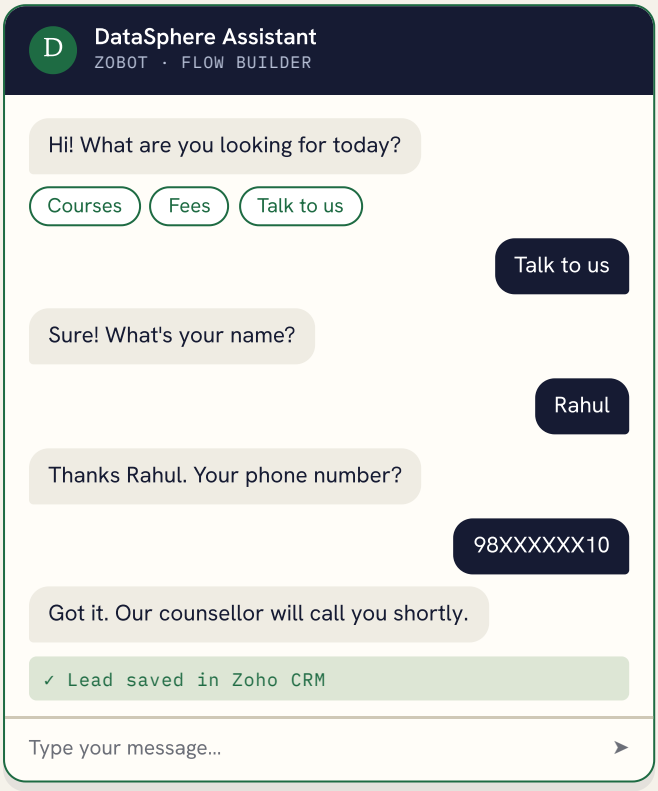
How to read the next pages: FITS works well · PARTLY works with limits or manual effort · DOESN'T FIT can't be relied on. Course names, fees and timings in the chats are sample values; the marks are based on Zoho's SalesIQ documentation and our SalesIQ account.

03 · Option 1

Zobot: the no-code flow builder

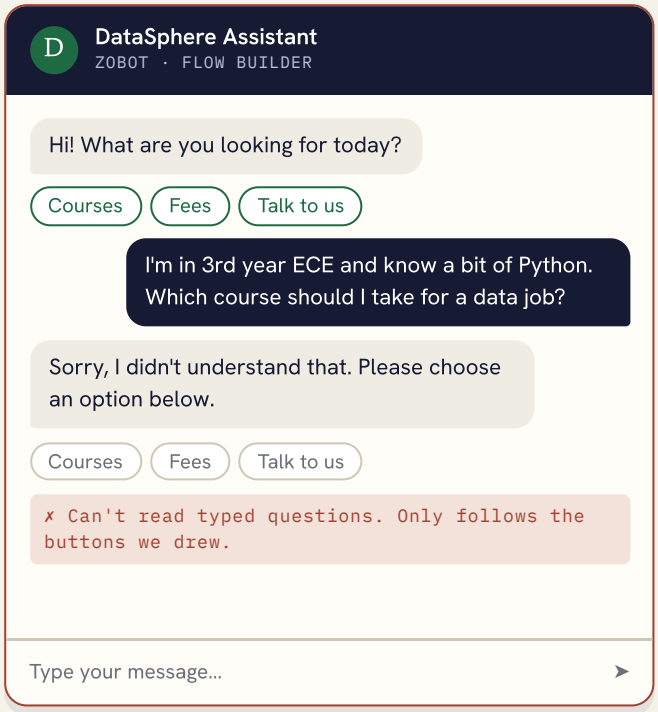
We draw the chat as a flowchart: buttons and questions → The student clicks through the path we drew → Answers are saved to Zoho CRM

WHERE IT WORKS · COLLECTING DETAILS



Button-driven forms work well. The student's details go straight into Zoho CRM.

WHERE IT FAILS · ASKING FOR ADVICE



The moment a student types a real question, the bot can only repeat its menu.

Correct answers	Suggests courses	Easy to update	Saves leads	Hands over	Matches our design
DOESN'T FIT	DOESN'T FIT	PARTLY	FITS	FITS	PARTLY

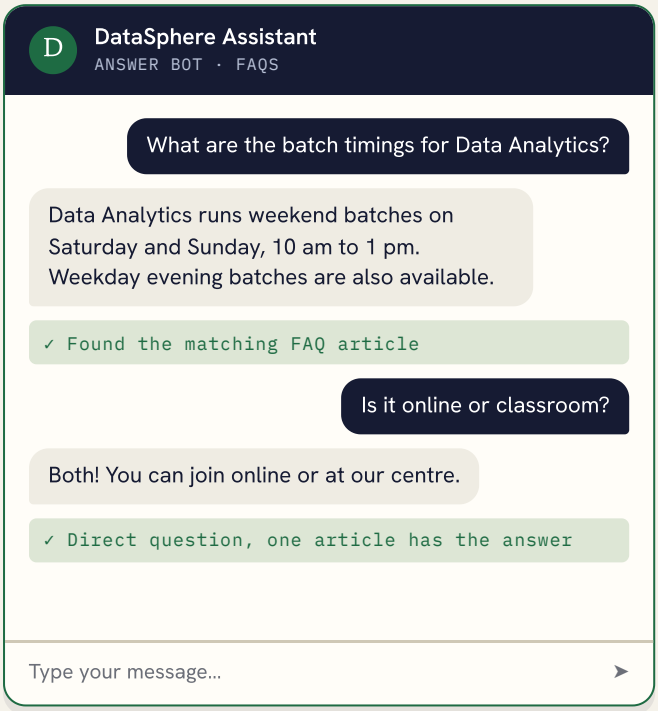
Why we can't use it: it's a form with buttons, not a conversation. To "recommend" courses we'd have to draw a branch for every background, skill and goal, which nobody could maintain.

04 · Option 2

Answer Bot: replies from our FAQs

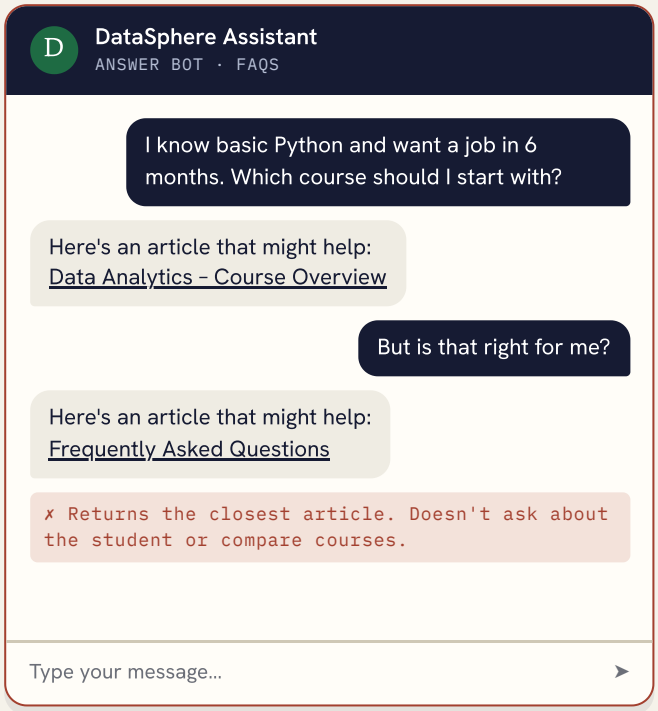
We add FAQs and articles to SalesIQ → The bot finds the closest article → Zoho's AI (Zia) rewords it as a reply

● WHERE IT WORKS · SIMPLE FACTS



Direct questions with a ready answer in one article work fine.

● WHERE IT FAILS · PERSONAL ADVICE



It answers from one article at a time. It can't understand the student and suggest a path.

Correct answers	Suggests courses	Easy to update	Saves leads	Hands over	Matches our design
PARTLY	DOESN'T FIT	PARTLY	PARTLY	FITS	PARTLY

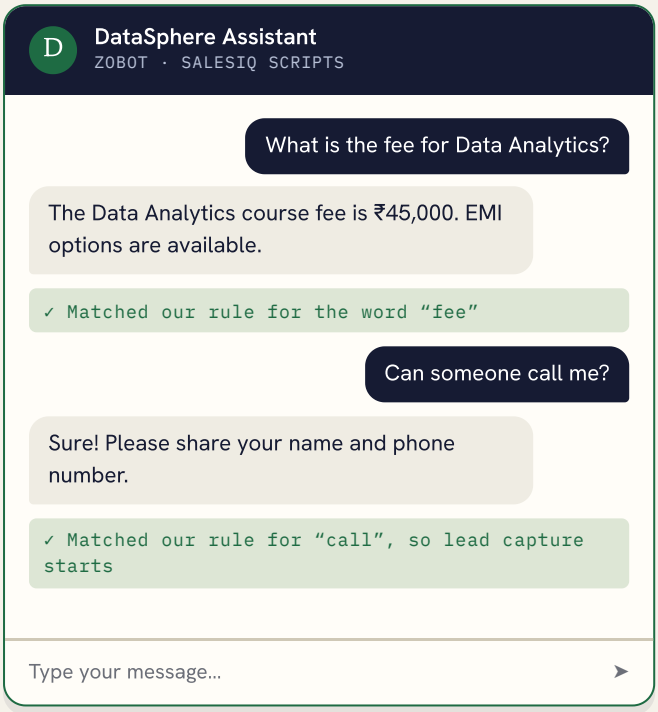
Why we can't use it: it's a search box over FAQs. All course info would have to be rewritten as articles and kept in sync by hand, and it still couldn't suggest courses or collect leads on its own.

05 · Option 3

Zobot with SalesIQ Scripts

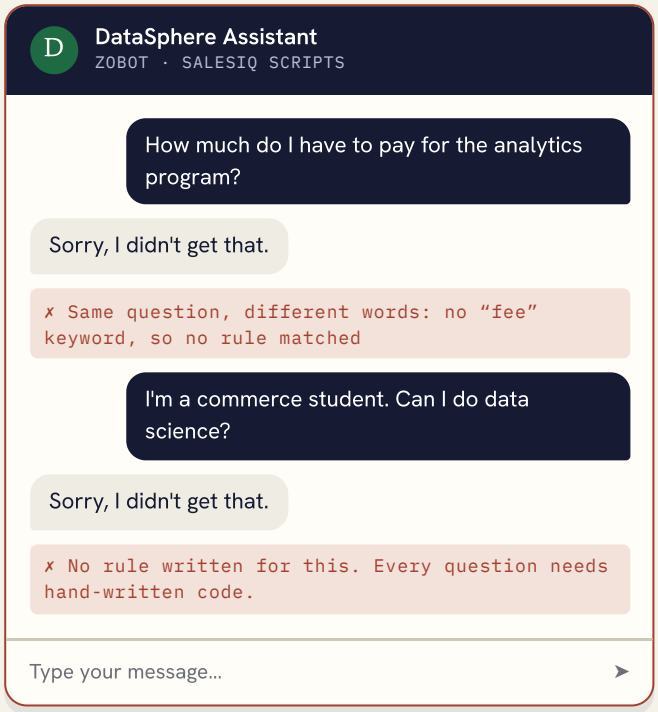
We write rules in Deluge, Zoho's own coding language → Each message is checked against our rules → The matching rule sends its reply

WHERE IT WORKS · EXACT KEYWORDS



Questions that contain the words we coded for get the right answer.

WHERE IT FAILS · REAL STUDENT QUESTIONS



Students don't use our keywords. Anything we didn't predict falls through.

Correct answers	Suggests courses	Easy to update	Saves leads	Hands over	Matches our design
PARTLY	DOESN'T FIT	DOESN'T FIT	FITS	FITS	PARTLY

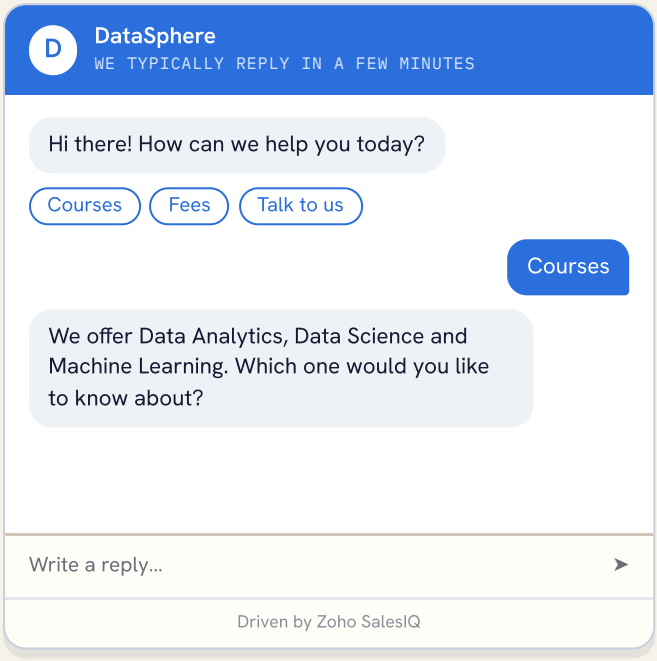
Why we can't use it: it isn't AI, just hand-written if/else rules. Every new question or fee change needs someone who knows Deluge, so the team couldn't update it on their own.

06 · A problem with all three options

The chat window can't look like our website

Whichever bot type we pick, the chat window itself is **SalesIQ's ready-made template**. We can only change what Zoho's settings allow. The new website will have its own fonts, colours and layout, and the chat window would still look like a Zoho add-on sitting on top of it.

SALESIQ WIDGET · ZOHO'S TEMPLATE



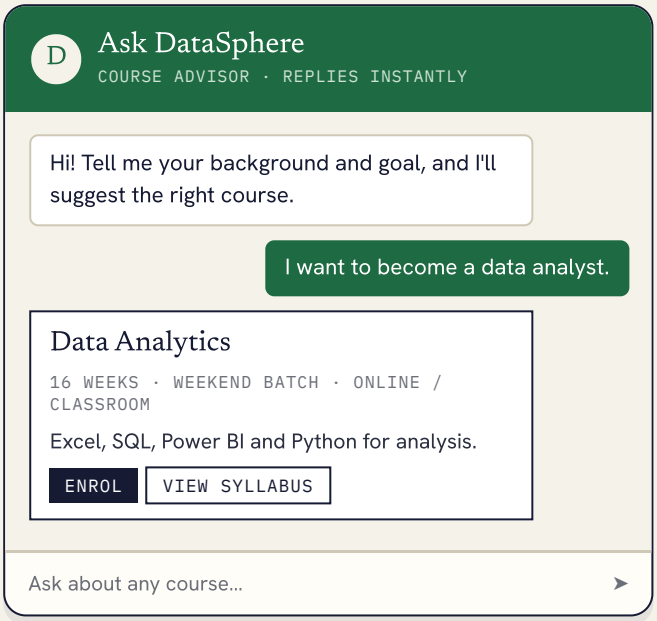
~ We can change: theme, colours, position, logo and greeting text

✗ Layout, chat bubbles and overall look stay Zoho's template

✗ Can't use our website's own design and components

✗ Feels like a third-party tool, not part of our site

OUR OWN WIDGET · BUILT FOR OUR SITE



✓ Same fonts, colours and style as the new website

✓ Our own course cards with Enrol and syllabus buttons

✓ We decide every detail: size, layout and behaviour on mobile

✓ Feels like part of DataSphere, not an add-on

Why this matters: we're rebuilding the website to look modern and consistent. A chat window we can't fully design would be the one part of the site that doesn't match.

The left mock-up is a simplified illustration of SalesIQ's default style, not a screenshot. Exact customisation options depend on our SalesIQ plan.

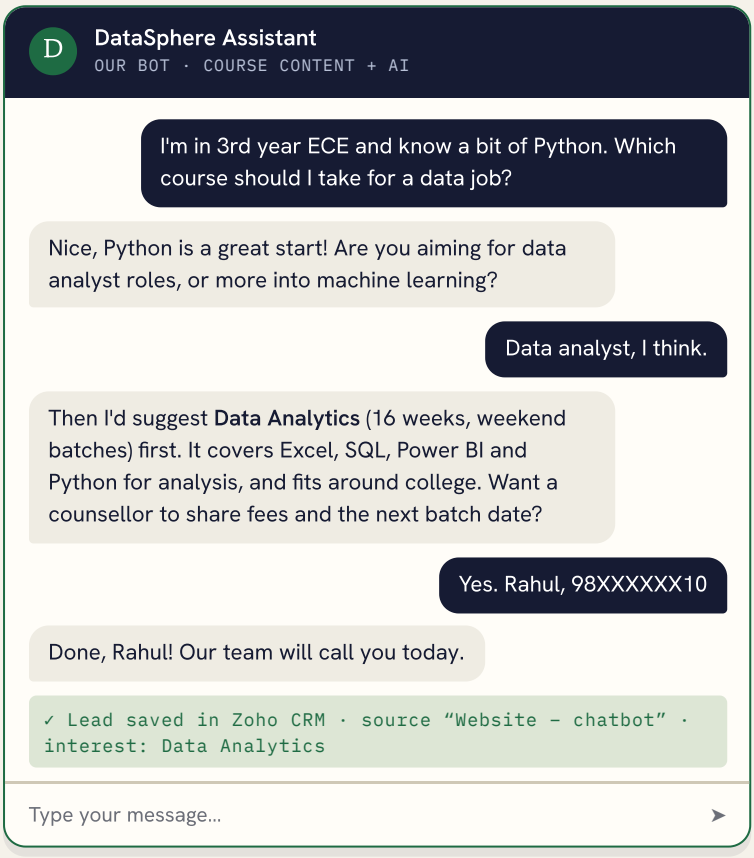
07 · The better option

Our own RAG chatbot, with leads saved in Zoho

Instead of Zoho's bots, we build a chatbot on our own course content (RAG + an AI model). It reads our course details, talks to the student in plain language, suggests the right course, and saves every interested student in **Zoho CRM**, so the team's follow-up stays exactly the same.

Student asks in their own words → **Our bot** looks up our course info (RAG) → **AI** writes the answer and suggests courses → **Zoho CRM** gets the lead automatically

THE SAME QUESTION EVERY ZOHO OPTION FAILED



Correct answers: only from our course info, so it never makes up a fee or date.

Suggests courses: asks a follow-up, then recommends.

Easy to update: the team edits one course sheet; the bot uses it.

Saves leads: name, phone and course go straight to Zoho CRM.

Hands over: offers a call-back whenever it can't help.

Matches our design: built in our own fonts, colours and layout.

NEED	ZOBOT (FLOW)	ANSWER BOT	ZOBOT + SCRIPTS	OUR RAG BOT
Correct answers	DOESN'T FIT	PARTLY	PARTLY	FITS
Suggests courses	DOESN'T FIT	DOESN'T FIT	DOESN'T FIT	FITS
Easy to update	PARTLY	PARTLY	DOESN'T FIT	FITS
Saves leads	FITS	PARTLY	FITS	FITS
Hands over	FITS	FITS	FITS	FITS
Matches our design	PARTLY	PARTLY	PARTLY	FITS